GED 3402 Music in Western Civilization

9.1: *Italian and French Opera*

Professor Chan Wing Wah
陈永华教授

Ancient Greece *Muses* the 9 Goddesses 缪斯女神

Mousika (music)



Mousika



Greek Theatre希腊剧场Ephesus, Turkey土耳其 以弗所



Bergamon, Turkey土耳其 巴格门



The Origin & Development of Opera 歌剧起源及发展

- Ancient **Greek and Roman** ritual ceremonies 希腊及罗马礼仪活动 combined worship and performance consisting of *dance, singing, poem narrating, marching*, etc.
- Medieval *liturgical drama*中世纪 礼仪剧 (**music + play**) on Bible stories.
- **Baroque Italian opera 17th century 十七世纪巴洛克时期的意大利歌剧:**
- Monteverdi: *l'Orfeo*, 1607
- Handel: *Serse*, 1737 *Ombra mai fu (Never was a Shadow)* https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=N7XH-58eB8c

- **Classical 18世纪 古典时期:**
- ***Mozart***: - Italian opera: *Le nozze de Figaro* (*The Marriage of Figaro*)费加诺的婚礼, *1786*
  German Opera: *Die Zauberflöte (The Magic Flute) 魔笛, 1791*
- **Romantic 19世纪 浪漫派歌剧:**
- ***Verdi*** *(1813-1901): Aida艾伊达, La Traviata茶花女*
- ***Puccini*** *(1858-1924): Madama Butterfly蝴蝶夫人, Turandot杜兰朵*
- German opera
- ***Wagner*** *(1813-1883): Mastersinger from Nuremberg纽伦堡的歌手, The Ring指环*

Libretto剧本: Librettist剧作家

- The opera stories 歌剧故事:

- 1.Greek mythology希腊神话,
- 2. Bible stories圣经故事,
- 3. Literature: Plays and novels 文学作品： 话剧及小说,
- 4. Folklore and legends 民间故事及传说,
- 5. Modern works 现代创作.

The Content of Opera 歌剧格式

***Opera** in musica* (**work** in music) - staged drama set to music

*Librettist*剧作家– libretto(text, story) ---- ***Composer*** 作曲家– music

Orchestral **Overture**/Prelude 序幕曲/前奏曲（乐队）

Aria 咏叹调（独唱）

Recitative /**Recit**ativo 宣叙调（独唱）

Duo/duet, trio, quartet ….chorus二重， 三重，四重….. 合唱

Orchestral **Interlude, Intermezzo** （乐队）间奏，间场曲

Finale, ensemble finale

Tragedy 悲剧 versus comedy喜剧，

Sing through 全唱 versus with spoken dialogue 口语对白.

Grand Opera, Chamber opera室内歌剧 and **Operetta轻歌剧**

Operetta 轻歌剧：a shorter opera, with spoken dialogue, singable melodies and dance

- French Operetta: Jacques **Offenbach** 1819-1880 (close to 100 operettas)
- ***Les Contes d'Hoffman***. *'The Tales of Hoffman'*, written by Jules Barbier, based on three short stories by E.T.A. Hoffman.
- *Barcarolle : Belle nuit d'amour (Lovely Night)* https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w30ireL6gUY
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fNrBr4Zc1Bg (La Vida es Bella)
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=D_YeTowgjKU (Roberto Begnini received Hon Doctorate at the University of Toronto)

- German Operetta: Johann Strauss 1825-1899 (16 operettas), Franz von Suppé,
- Franz **Lehar**: *Die lustige Witwe* , ***'Merry Widow'风流寡妇***.
- *Librettist:* Victor Léon and Leo Stein, based on Henri Meilhac's play.
- *We're the Ladies of the Chorus* https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jxEXiUG0_tM sung in English

- **Operetta influenced and inspired ***Broadway musicals***

The Relationship Between **Mozart** and Lorenzo da Ponte

Mozart had written **22** operas

- ***Le Nozze di Figaro***, ***'The Marriage of Figaro'*** 费加罗的婚礼, *K.492, 1786*
- Da Ponte wrote the libretto based on Beaumarchais's earlier play written in French in 1773. Da Ponte removed the sensitive political speech and changed the language to Italian.
- Full opera https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qtDQvKB4kvA
- ***Non so piu cosa son*** (I do not know anymore what I am)
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J9usaRXn1IA with English surtitle
- ***Non piu andrai*** (No more, you) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bKBGRO-GYYo with English surtitle

- ***Don Giovanni***, *K.527; 1787*
- Spanish Renaissance legend *Don Juan* became a 17th century play written by Tirso de Molina. Da Ponte wrote the libretto into Italian.
- ***La ci darem la mano,*** (*Give Me Your Hand)* https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GADW9XYoLBY

- ***Cosi Fan Tutte***, *(So Do They All), K.588. 1790*

Gioachino Rossini罗西尼 1792-1868

- *Guillaume Tell (William Tell)* 1829 an opera in French: *Overture*
  https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j3T8-aeOrbg

- Tokyo Philharmonic Orchestra 100th Anniversary Special Concert Myung-Whun Chung鄭明勳

- William Tell is a folk hero and a cross bow marksman in the 14th century Switzerland. Note the horse galloping rhythm in the music like William Tell in the forest.



Giuseppe Verdi 威尔第 1813-1901 https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Giuseppe_Verdi

: *La Traviata* 茶花女

- ***La Dame aux Camélias*** 茶花女(literally ***The Lady with the Camellias***, commonly known in English as ***Camille***) is a novel by Alexandre Dumas fils小仲马, first published in 1848 and subsequently adapted for the stage. *La Dame aux Camélias* was premiered in Paris, France on February 2, 1852. The play was an instant success, and Verdi immediately set about putting the story to music. His work became the 1853 ***La Traviata***, with the female protagonist, Marguerite Gautier, renamed Violetta Valéry.
- In the English-speaking world, *La Dame aux Camélias* became known as *Camille* and 16 versions have been performed at Broadway theatres alone.
- Whole opera, Overture finishes at 4:50 and curtain rises, the famous Brindisi comes at 10:01. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gVbAdncN3JY

- *Brindisi* 饮酒歌 with English surtitle: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=afhAqMeeQJk

Verdi: *Rigoletto*弄臣, 1851

- Francesco Maria Piave wrote the Italian libretto based on the French play *Le roi s'amuse* (1832) by Victor Hugo雨果1802-1885.
- *La Donna È Mobile*善变的女人https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xCFEk6Y8TmM Pavarotti
- Woman is flighty.
  Like a feather in the wind,
  she changes in voice
  and in thought.

  Always a lovely,
  pretty face,
  in tears or in laughter,
  it is untrue.

  Refrain
  Woman is fickle.
  Like a feather in the wind,
  she changes her words
  and her thoughts!

Verdi: *Aida* 艾伊达 1871

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Aida

- *Triumphant Marches* https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=l3w4I-KElxQ
- Enjoy the pompous and victorious Triumphant Marches with the big scenes.

- Whole opera : https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b8rsOzPzYr8

Giacomo Puccini 普契尼 1858-1924

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Giacomo_Puccini

- *Madama Butterfly* 蝴蝶夫人1904,1907 https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Madama_Butterfly

- *Un Bel Di Vedremo* (One Fine Day) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2V8s9CW4DTA
  Anna Netrebko in the Waldbühne Concert, Berlin

- One fine day we'll notice
  a thread of smoke arising
  on the sea, in the far horizon,
  and then the ship appearing;
  Then the trim white vessel
  glides into the harbour, thunders forth her cannon.

Puccini : Gianni Schicchi 1917-18

- Anna Netrebko. *"O mio babbino caro«(My Dear Father)*
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=g0Kcg7WEJME *Anna Netrebko*

- Oh my dear papa
  I like him, he is so handsome.
  I want to go to Porta Rossa
  To buy the ring!
  Yes, yes, I want to go there!
  And if my love were in vain,
  I would go to the Ponte Vecchio
  And throw myself in the Arno!
  I am pining, I am tormented!
  Oh God, I would want to die!
  Father, have pity, have pity!

Puccini：*Turandot* 杜兰朵 1926 https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Turandot

- *Nessun Dorma* 今夜无人能睡 https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=k28WStNnTLQ

- None shall sleep! None shall sleep!
  Not even you, oh Princess,
  in your cold bedroom,
  watching the stars
  that tremble with love, and with hope!
- But my secret is hidden within me;
  no one will know my name!
  No, no! On your mouth,
  I will say it when the light shines!
- And my kiss will dissolve
  the silence that makes you mine!
- No one will know his name,
  and we will have to, alas, die, die!
- Vanish, o night!
  Fade, you stars!
  Fade, you stars!
  At dawn, I will win!
  I will win! I will win!

Pietro Mascagni (1863-1945). *Intermezzo* 間奏曲 from *Cavalleria Rusticana* 乡村骑士

- Enjoy the lyricism and very touching melodic lines. Close your eyes and listen, most people cried at listening to this piece of orchestral music.
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K8YXU0ZuE_k Filarmonica della Scala, Myung-Whun Chung 鄭明勛

Georges Bizet 1838-1875：*Carmen* 1875

- Prosper Mérimée (1803-1870) : pioneer of novella, a sort novel. He is also an archaeologist, historian and well known in architectural preservation. *Carmen* is his best novella.
- Libretto by Henri Meilhac and Ludovic Halévy
- *Carmen Overture*.
- Orchestre Philharmonique de Radio France ,Myung-Whun Chung 鄭明勛
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LdqTaII_xXg
- "*L'amour est un oiseau rebelle« Love is a rebellious bird*
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K2snTkaD64U
- *Toreador* 鬬牛勇士之歌(El Torero Escamillo)
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CoV2YOjFowY

Opéra comique, founded in 1714

Théâtre national de l'Opéra-Comique

Place Boïeldieu, Paris



Famous Opera House in Europe

- *Top 5 Opera House in Italy*: http://slowitaly.yourguidetoitaly.com/top-opera-houses-in-italy/
- Royal Opera House, Covent Garden, London, UK 1732
- Teatro di San Carlo, Napoli, Italy 1737
- Staatsoper Unter den Linden, Berlin State Opera, Germany 1742
- Teatro Comunale di Bologna, Italy 1763
- Teatro alla Scala, Milano, Italy 1778
- Teatro la Fenice, Venezia, Italy 1792
- Bavarian State Opera, Munich, Germany 1818
- Gran Teatre de Liceu, Barcelona, Spain1847
- Palais Garnier, Paris, France 1875
- Teatro Massimo, Palermo, Sicily, Italy 1897
- *Metropolitan Opera, New York, USA 1880

Palais Garnier, Paris



Opera going = a life style in European culture

- In England, people go to watch a *play*. In Germany, people go to a *symphony* concert. In Italy, people go to an *opera*. In France, people go to a *ballet*.
- Opera going is a social gathering with light food and drinks before and during intermission. Then they go for dinner or a light meal afterwards.
- It is a symbol of the upper class and a sign of high culture. Even today in Europe, people are generally well dressed to go to cultural events in particular opera.
- There is surely an opera house in almost every city in Europe. The tradition spreads to Asia as early as early 20th century.
- In USA, people are more fond of going to *Broadway musicals*.